new Latitude and Precision laptops. Do those rely on the webcam?

Vivekanand: The device captures the image through the camera. That is not the webcam, but the camera that is embedded within the PC itself. With all the Dell models, you can opt for an inbuilt webcam itself, but it only uses the webcam to capture the video or the image. It also uses Intel Context Sensing Service. Then, the Dell Optimizer's artificial intelligence tool makes sense out of the signal from the Intel Context Sensing Service and uses the image and then learns. After which it then is able to give the right recommendations around what needs to be done to the screen. In case, like I said, there's a physical intrusion behind the user, or the user himself chooses to, you know, move to the left or the right, the screen gets texturised to protect whatever is being displayed. So it's a combination of software that is Dell's technology and the image that is captured and Intel's technology that brings this feature to bear.

As for the optimisations that Dell Optimizer has, how is it different from what Intel's own technology does at the below OS level? Why is there a need for a separate optimizer application? Because windows themselves, I would say, claim that they do a really good job.

Vivekanand: To give you a quick answer, the Dell Optimizer has various other features. It's not just about threat detection. The Dell Optimizer, in this version, has launched two incremental features. However, if you go back and see the full list of features that the Dell Optimizer has then it offers other features like ExpressSign-in, ExpressResponse, ExpressCharge and a few others. Specifically, I want to talk about ExpressResponse. ExpressResponse is a feature where the Dell Optimizer actually understands, during the first one week of buying the notebook, how the user uses the notebook. What are the most frequently used applications and the resource-intensive applications, depending on each user's work profile. Once it learns that, it then starts allocating all system resources to ensure that those set of applications respond faster so that the user experience is better.

The second one is ExpressCharge. So it basically ensures that in case your battery is running low, it adjusts various other system parameters so that you can get more out of the battery. How many times have there been instances where you are in the middle of a very critical call and your battery says that it just has one per cent charge and goes into shutdown mode? So such instances are averted.

Then you also have ExpressSign-in which was the first feature we launched about three-to-four years ago, where with Intel's Context Sensing Service, if you buy it with the IR camera, it seamlessly signs in the user, through facial detection. That ensures that a lot of time that is spent typing in user ID and password can be avoided.

The other very important feature which comes with Dell Optimizer is called Intelligent Audio. So what it does is that it has active noise cancellation and it reduces ambient noise, et cetera, so that you have a conference-like experience when you use your regular PC. It's got various other features to ensure that notes are crisp and clearer. So the audio output is at a premium. So these are four standard features in addition to a few others, which came in the previous generations, which continue to come. So in summary, what Intel offers such as TPM is hardware-based security and the Dell Optimizer is actually a comprehensive software, which gives you various other features as well. It's essentially an AI engine that gives the best user experience possible from the PC by learning what the user is doing.

And is the, let's say user data, being kept purely on the client device itself, or are you using anonymized data to sort of improve the service overall?

Vivekanand: So if the IT admin chooses to move that data out the PC, he can. But it can be controlled so that it doesn't move any data out. Unless the organisation wishes to do so. So we don't take out any data through the Dell Optimizer unless it is enabled by the IT team itself.

Do any of the features that you'd mentioned pertaining to the Dell Optimizer require any GPU (IGP or discrete GPU) acceleration for optimal performance? Or is it a little simpler in terms of implementation?

Vivekanand: No, no additional GPU is required for running the optimizer.

Another point that you touched upon was sustainability. And to be honest, there are a lot of brands speaking about the same thing. You mentioned how the packaging is now made of hundred per cent recycled materials and it can be recycled. But on the device itself, what is the extent of recycled materials or sustainable materials being used?

Vivekanand: I can't give you an accurate answer because it varies between devices, right? Our endeavour is to make sure that we largely use ocean recycled plastic for, as an example, the cover in some of our notebooks. We are strongly committed to reducing the carbon footprint through our 2030 moonshot goals, which is actually available in our annual reports as well. And specifically in this particular refresh of products, what I just called out was that we've actually accelerated that progress. What we said we would do in 2030, we are doing it now by introducing the first packaging that's made with a hundred per cent recycled materials.

As for the security features, most of these devices, be it the Latitude series or the Precision series, tend to use Intel processors with vPro features or AMD Ryzen processors with Pro features, right?

Vivekanand: Yeah. Right now, barring one tower workstation, our entire portfolio is on Intel. We are yet to offer on the commercial line of PCs, on the mobility lineup specifically, we are purely an Intel roadmap right now. We don't have AMD. We do offer an AMD Threadripper model on the tower workstations but not on the commercial laptops.